Ukraine's Starlink Is Back at Full Speed After a Week of Limits

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Ukraine's satellite internet is working at full speed again, after more than a week of connection problems. The news came on Saturday, when tech billionaire Elon Musk said his company SpaceX had restricted the service, and Ukraine's leaders said speeds were back where they needed to be.

Starlink is a network of satellites that **beams** internet down from low **orbit** around Earth. In Ukraine, it helps military units stay in touch, especially in remote areas where regular phone and internet networks do not reach. Ukraine also uses a separate, more secure system called **Starshield**, which is controlled by the United States government.

Musk said SpaceX had restricted Starlink because, in his view, Ukraine had broken the service's rules by using it for military activity. He also said SpaceX had done more to defend Ukraine than any private company on Earth. He denied being responsible for a problem with **Starshield** at the same time.

The connection trouble began last week, during a disagreement between Washington and Kyiv over Ukrainian **strikes** on oil sites inside Russia. United States President Donald Trump said he had told Musk to put the service back, after earlier denying that he had told him to limit it.

One Ukrainian official, Beskrestnov, pushed back. Writing on Telegram, he said Starlink **terminals** in Ukraine already had a speed limit of 70 to 90 kilometres per hour and did not work on Russian territory, so they physically could not be used for deep **strikes**.

Ukraine's defence minister, Yevhenii Khmara, said on Saturday that the military now had a stable connection, with drones able to reach speeds above 400 kilometres per hour. President Volodymyr Zelensky wrote that the speeds are now where they need to be. Musk did not explain in his post why SpaceX had made the change last week.

Word Treasure

orbit -- The path an object follows as it travels around the Earth.

terminals -- Small dishes or devices that connect to a satellite network to send and receive signals.

Starshield -- A separate, more secure satellite system used in Ukraine and controlled by the United States government.

strikes -- Attacks aimed at a particular target.

beams -- Sends out in a straight stream, like light from a torch.

Background you need

A satellite is an object in orbit around Earth that can send and receive signals, and a network of many satellites can carry internet to places on the ground.

Low orbit means a satellite travels fairly close to Earth, so its signals reach the ground quickly.

In remote areas ordinary phone and internet networks may not reach, so people there depend on satellites to stay in touch.

A drone is a small flying machine that is controlled from a distance rather than flown by a pilot on board.

Break it down

LEAD: Ukraine's satellite internet is working at full speed again after more than a week of connection problems.

KEY EVENT: On Saturday, Elon Musk said SpaceX had restricted the service, and Ukraine's leaders said speeds were back where they needed to be.

+- WHO: Musk and SpaceX, Ukraine's leaders, President Donald Trump, and Ukrainian official Beskrestnov.

+- WHAT: Starlink helps military units stay in touch, especially in remote areas, while Starshield is a separate, more secure system controlled by the United States government.

+- WHEN: The trouble began last week, during a disagreement between Washington and Kyiv over Ukrainian strikes on oil sites inside Russia.

EVIDENCE: Beskrestnov said Starlink terminals in Ukraine already had a speed limit of 70 to 90 kilometres per hour and did not work on Russian territory.

OPEN QUESTION: Musk did not explain in his post why SpaceX had made the change last week.

Why it matters

When satellite internet is limited, soldiers and people in remote areas can lose contact, so who controls that connection -- and why it is switched on or off -- can affect safety and communication in a war.

Test what you remember

1. What is working at full speed again in Ukraine?

- (A) Ukraine's satellite internet, Starlink
- (B) A new rocket service
- (C) The Starshield system only
- (D) Regular phone networks everywhere

2. Why did Musk say SpaceX had restricted Starlink?

- (A) Because of bad weather
- (B) Because Ukraine had stopped paying
- (C) Because Ukraine had broken the service's rules by using it for military activity, in his view
- (D) Because the satellites had fallen down

3. What speed limit did Beskrestnov say Starlink terminals in Ukraine already had?

- (A) 400 kilometres per hour
- (B) 10 kilometres per hour
- (C) No speed limit at all
- (D) 70 to 90 kilometres per hour

4. According to Beskrestnov, why could the terminals not be used for deep strikes?

- (A) They had no internet at all
- (B) They were controlled by Kyiv only
- (C) They were too expensive
- (D) They did not work on Russian territory

5. What did Ukraine's defence minister say on Saturday?

- (A) Starlink had been switched off for good
- (B) The internet was still completely down
- (C) The military now had a stable connection, with drones able to reach speeds above 400 kilometres per hour
- (D) Ukraine no longer needed satellites

6. What did Trump say about the service?

- (A) He had bought SpaceX
- (B) He had never spoken to Musk
- (C) He had ordered Starlink to close forever
- (D) He had told Musk to put the service back, after earlier denying that he had told him to limit it

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: A 2: C 3: D 4: D 5: C 6: D

Questions to think about

1. Elon Musk: SpaceX restricted Starlink because, in his view, Ukraine had broken the service's rules by using it for military activity; he also said SpaceX had done more to defend Ukraine than any private company on Earth.

2. Donald Trump: He said he had told Musk to put the service back, after earlier denying that he had told him to limit it.

3. Beskrestnov: Starlink terminals in Ukraine already had a speed limit of 70 to 90 kilometres per hour and did not work on Russian territory, so they physically could not be used for deep strikes.

4. Yevhenii Khmara and Volodymyr Zelensky: The military now has a stable connection, and speeds are now where they need to be.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):